4 · Technical documentation index

The technical documentation index is the first page of a product's Annex VII file. It lists every required content item, the artefact that satisfies it, its owner, where it is kept and its status. Art 31 requires the file before placing on the market; keep the index in the system of record and update it at every release gate.

At a glance

Item	Detail
Legal basis	Art 31; Annex VII pts 1-8; Art 13(12)-(13); Art 13(22)
Needed for	Every conformity route; any market surveillance request; the notified-body application under Module B or H
Owner	Compliance lead
Approver	Head of product security
When to create	At project start; populate as artefacts are produced
When to update	At each release gate, each placing of a new version and each substantial modification
Retention	10 years after placing or the support period, whichever is longer (Art 13(13))
Feeds	Draws on Templates 1-3 and 5-9; supports Template 10

How to complete

1. Fill the control block: product, variants, file version, retention date and language.
2. For each Annex VII row, name the artefact, owner, location and version.
3. Link every artefact to a controlled record in the system of record, never to a mailbox or personal drive.
4. If one file covers a family, complete the variant list.
5. Mark status per row and close gaps before the release gate.
6. Freeze a copy of the index with each placing on the market.

Template

Part A: control block

Field	What to enter	Basis	Example: L2 Smart Lock (illustrative)
File ID and version	[TF-ID], [version], [date]	Art 31	TF-L2 v1.0
Product and variants	[Family; variant list in Part C]	Guidance paras 174-177	L2 Smart Lock, 3 SKUs
Conformity route	[From Template 1]	Art 32	Module B+C (planned)
Retention end	[10 years after last placing, or end of support period, whichever is later]	Art 13(13)	[Date]
Working language	[Any language; translation plan for authorities]	Art 13(22)	English; translation on request
System of record	[GRC platform, document-management system or compliance tool with audit trail]	Evidence governance	[Tool name]
Legacy design relief	[Yes or no; scope]	Guidance pts 37-39	[Yes, for design phases before 11 Dec 2027]

Part B: Annex VII index

Document names show illustrative L2 entries. Point 1 is split into 1(a)-1(d) (sub-lettering for this kit; the regulation numbers point 1 as one item).

Annex VII point	Content required	Document / artefact	Owner	Location (system of record)	Version	Status
1(a)	General description, including intended purpose; core functionality (guidance para 144)	Classification record CR-L2-01 (Template 1); product definition record	Product security officer	[Path]	[v]	[Draft / Approved / Missing]

Annex VII point	Content required	Document / artefact	Owner	Location (system of record)	Version	Status
1(b)	Versions of software affecting compliance with essential requirements	Release manifest per firmware and app version	Release manager	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
1(c)	For hardware: photographs or illustrations of external features, marking and internal layout	Photo set PH-L2	Hardware lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
1(d)	User information and instructions under Annex II	Annex II document (Template 6) and its URL	Technical writing	[URL]	[v]	[ ]
2(a)	Design and development: drawings and system architecture showing how software components build on or feed into each other	Architecture document; data-flow diagram DFD-L2	Engineering lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
2(b)	Vulnerability handling: SBOM, CVD policy, evidence of the reporting contact address, secure update distribution	SBOM per release; CVD policy (Template 7); security.txt capture; update design note	PSIRT lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
2(c)	Production and monitoring processes, with validation	Build, signing and release process; gate records	Quality lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
3	Cybersecurity risk assessment under Art 13, with Part I applicability and justifications	RA-L2 (Template 2) with change log	Product security officer	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
4	Information used to determine the support period under Art 13(8)	SP-L2-01 (Template 3); version-support register	Product manager	[Path]	[v]	[ ]

Annex VII point	Content required	Document / artefact	Owner	Location (system of record)	Version	Status
5	Harmonised standards, common specifications or certification schemes applied in full or in part; otherwise the solutions adopted	Standards statement, with drafts labelled "draft"	Compliance lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
6	Test reports on the product against Annex I Part I	Test reports indexed by requirement	Test lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
6	Test reports on vulnerability-handling processes against Annex I Part II	Process audit and PSIRT test records	PSIRT lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
7	Copy of the EU declaration of conformity	Declaration (Template 5)	Compliance lead	[Path]	[v]	[ ]
8	SBOM, where applicable, supplied on a market surveillance authority's reasoned request	SBOM annex per version	SBOM owner	[Path]	[v]	[ ]

No harmonised standard is cited in the OJ as of 30 Oct 2026, so point 5 will describe the solutions adopted.

Part C: family variant list

One file may cover a family sharing architecture, security-relevant design, intended purpose and risks (guidance pts 174-177).

Variant	Model and SKU	Differences from reference variant	Affected risk-assessment rows	Separate evidence	Declared end of support
Reference	L2-STD (illustrative)	None	None	Full set	[Month, year]
[Variant]	[SKU]	[Interface, stack, update or connectivity differences]	[e.g. 2(i), 2(j)]	[Tests]	[Month, year]

A different update mechanism or remote connectivity usually means a new family, not a variant.

Part D: obligations around the file

Obligation	What to record	Basis
File complete before placing	Date the file was frozen for this version	Art 31; Art 13(12)
Kept current	Update log through the support period	Art 31
Retention	Retention end date per placing	Art 13(13)
Reasoned request	Named contact; translation route into a language the authority can easily understand	Art 13(22)
Legacy relief	Design phases where test evidence is replaced by the risk assessment; Part II evidence still held	Guidance pts 37-39
Publication	Not owed to customers or the public, except FOSS self-attesting under Art 32(5)	Commission FAQ 6.6

The simplified Annex VII format for micro and small enterprises (Art 33(5)) depends on an implementing act. None is adopted, drafted or scheduled as of 30 Oct 2026, so build the full file.

Common mistakes

- Assembling evidence by hand when asked. Emit gate records, SBOM hashes and test results at release and index them here.
- Keeping the file on a shared drive. It needs controlled versions, access management and an audit trail.
- Overwriting the file for a new version. Each placing freezes a set; earlier versions stay retained.
- Calling products a family because they share a brand. An engineer must be able to name the shared security architecture document.
- Leaving the manufacturer-built backend out of points 2(a) and 3.

Template 4 · v1.0 · 31 Oct 2026 · Not legal advice; confirm wording against the Official Journal text before use.